



PREDICTED TEAM

Matthew Breetzke
Mitchell Marsh
Nicholas Pooran
David Miller
Ayush Badoni
Shahbaz Ahmed
Ravi Bishnoi
Avesh Khan
Mohsin Khan
Akash Deep

IMPACT PLAYER

Arshin Kulkarni/Mayank Yadav

COACH

Justin Langer

HOME VENUE

Bharat Ratna Shri Atal Bihari
Vajpayee Ekana International
Cricket Stadium, Lucknow

LAST SEASON

Seventh

At snail's pace

8.10

Since 2023, Lucknow Super Giants' run rate during the PowerPlay has been 8.10 — the lowest among all teams. Despite this glaring inefficiency, the management failed to address the issue at the IPL 2025 auction. Unless it takes a bold approach by promoting a middle-order batter like Nicholas Pooran or Ayush Badoni, Lucknow's top-three options remain limited to Aiden Markram, Matthew Breetzke, Mitch Marsh, and Arshin Kulkarni. Among Marsh, Markram, and Breetzke, Marsh boasts the highest PowerPlay strike rate in the IPL (140). However, to accommodate both Pooran and David Miller in the XI, only two of the three overseas batters can be slotted into the top order. Given Markram's underwhelming PowerPlay strike rate of 90, he appears the likeliest to be left out. This still leaves the team relying on the 20-year-old Kulkarni, who has featured in just two IPL matches, to deliver beyond expectations.

Subdued by turn

123.61

Given Lucknow Super Giants' left-heavy middle order, opposing teams are likely to deploy left-arm wrist spinners and right-arm off-spinners. Nicholas Pooran, Rishabh Pant, and David Miller have a combined strike rate of 123.61 against these types of bowlers — only marginally above the average and significantly lower than their combined strike rate of 155 against pacers. This presents a major challenge for LSG at the Ekana International Cricket Stadium, where spinners have historically dominated. Since 2023, slow bowlers at Lucknow's home venue have conceded just 6.41 runs per over. Their control is particularly evident in the middle overs (7-15), where batters have managed a strike rate of only 116.23. With Pooran, Pant, and Miller likely occupying positions four, five, and six, respectively, opposition teams could use this trend to their advantage, applying spin pressure in the middle overs to stifle LSG's scoring.

Compounding the issue, LSG's top order has already shown signs of vulnerability. If the middle order also struggles against spin, it could severely impact its batting prospects and, consequently, its home campaign.